“But wait a minute,” you may say. “Why can’t you use plain old objects and exceptions to recover from failures?” Normally, exceptions are used to back out of a series of actions to prevent an inconsistent state rather than to recover from a failure in the sense we have been discussing. In the next section, let’s see how hard it would be to add fault recovery using exception handling and plain old objects.

NOTE This chapter does not cover the tooling for recovering from catastrophic failure. If a computer bursts into flames, you need to have an Akka cluster in place. Chapter 8 dives into that topic.

5.1.1 Plain old objects and exceptions

Let’s look at an example of an application that receives logs from multiple threads, parses interesting information out of the files into row objects, and writes these rows into a database. A file-watcher process keeps track of added files and informs many threads in some way to process them. Figure 5.1 depicts an overview of the application and highlights the parts we’ll zoom in on (those that are *in scope*).